government on their doors'. Not everyone was under suspicion or pressure. Xing tells us that some 'continued to flourish, open new businesses, and even came out in support of the Indian government' and donated to the National Defence Fund.[30] During the war of 1962, matters worsened, though, when many in the Chinese community were interned in camps and dispersed to places like Deoli in faraway Rajasthan. In some cases, they were deported to China even if they were born and raised in India and were dispossessed of their properties without compensation. The travails of the Chinese community have been poignantly fictionalized in the Assamese writer Rita Chowdhury's *Chinatown Days*. Reflecting on the book, she writes: 'Those who were young during that turbulent time had all grown old now. The rest of them, deeply embittered by the dreadful memories of the time and its insufferable aftermath, migrated to different parts of the world . . . The agony that had maimed their psyche forever still ran deep in their spirits . . . What moved me the most was their unflinching love for Makum – the place of their birth [in Assam] . . .'[31]

Elite views of China

We will get a flavour of Indian elite perspectives on China and the Chinese when we deal with Indian worldviews later in the chapter. Suffice to say here that among the moderate-liberal nationalists of the nineteenth and early twentieth centuries, China may well have appeared in the way that the British saw it: like India, it was big but brittle, internally divided and weak, and governed by aloof despots. Among the emerging Indian nationalists including Mahatma Gandhi, Jawaharlal Nehru, and Subhas Chandra Bose, China was a fellow Asian victim of imperialism trying to oust the European powers and reform its own society – much as India was trying to do. It was also a potential partner in the project of Asian unity, along with Japan (at least until Japanese militarism reared its head) – this was most famously Tagore's message but is evident in Gandhi, Nehru, and Bose. Among Indian socialists and communists, China's growing revolutionary spirit was an